

All the pages your site contains should at least have links to your home page and major sections. The easiest way to do this would be to have a constant navigation bar that has a fixed position on every page of your site. A good rule to follow is the three-click rule: no page in your site should be more than three clicks away from any other page.

Being Over-Creative

Sometimes, designers have delusions of grandeur, and think they would make good copy writers or visualisers in advertising agencies. This leads to sites that are cryptic to the common man. Such sites might be acceptable if the business or individual is attempting to show off their creative prowess—as might be the case with an actual copy writer or advertising agency, or perhaps an artist's home page. However, most often, such sites are a big no-no for the majority.

The problem lies in the fact that as the creative juices flow, the results often become more cryptic than creative. Take the site www.1amp.com. A visit to the site will have you waiting for a few minutes for everything to load at first—it's Flash-based. Once that's done, you see tiny links at the bottom of the Flash animation. Each link takes you to a cryptic Flash page, which will confuse you with its unorthodox link placement. To make matters worse, at the end of everything, you will have gone through the whole site and, at best, only be able to guess what AMP as a company does. Having to guess is bad! The only time people like guessing is in games—every other instance of guessing makes people uncomfortable and irritated.

Our guess is that AMP is an advertising agency, but the fact that we're still not sure is proof enough that their site is a failure. Now, such a site for a company not dealing with creativity as a product would be sheer madness. [1amp.com](http://www.1amp.com) won the dubious distinction of being used as an example for "The biggest Web design mistakes of 2004" at the popular site www.web-pagethatsuck.com.